

Guide Connect – MVP Strategy & Product Plan

Overview

Guide Connect is a travel assistance platform designed to help travelers easily connect with verified local guides and create structured day-wise travel itineraries within a city. The platform focuses on simplifying travel experiences by solving the discovery, trust, and planning challenges faced by tourists.

The MVP (Minimum Viable Product) focuses on two core modules: 1. Local Guide Marketplace 2. Smart Trip Planner (Day-wise itinerary creation)

These two modules together form the foundation of a scalable two-sided travel marketplace.

Problem Statement

Travelers visiting new cities frequently face:

- Difficulty discovering reliable local guides
- Language barriers and communication gaps
- Risk of scams or overpriced guide services
- Lack of structured trip planning tools
- Fragmented information across multiple apps

Local guides also face:

- Lack of digital visibility
- Dependency on intermediaries/agents
- Irregular income opportunities

Guide Connect bridges this gap by enabling direct connections between travelers and verified guides.

Proposed Solution

Guide Connect provides:

- Instant discovery of nearby local guides
- Transparent hourly pricing
- Verified guide profiles
- Language-based filtering
- Structured day-wise itinerary planning

The MVP focuses on solving the core discovery and planning problems before expanding into advanced AI-based travel assistance.

Target Users

Primary target users:

- Domestic travelers visiting unfamiliar cities
- Budget travelers and students
- Religious tourism visitors
- First-time visitors exploring heritage cities

Initial launch cities (recommended):

- Varanasi
- Ayodhya
- Agra
- Jaipur

These cities have high tourist density and strong demand for guide services.

MVP Scope

Module 1: Guide Connect (Marketplace)

Traveler Features:

- Select city
- Browse available guides
- View guide profile
- View languages spoken
- View hourly rate
- Request booking

Guide Features:

- Profile creation
- Set availability
- Upload verification details
- Accept/reject booking requests

Admin Features:

- Guide profile verification
 - Booking monitoring
 - Marketplace moderation
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Module 2: Smart Trip Planner

Traveler Features:

- Select city
- Choose number of travel days
- Select places to visit
- Auto-generate day-wise itinerary
- Distance-based clustering of locations

This helps travelers efficiently explore cities with minimal planning effort.

Out-of-Scope Features (Future Phases)

The following features are intentionally excluded from the MVP:

- AI camera-based travel assistant
- Expense splitting system
- Hotel booking integrations
- Restaurant recommendation engine
- Payment gateway automation

These features will be introduced after validating marketplace traction.

Business Model

Primary Revenue Source:

- Commission per guide booking (10%–25%)

Future Revenue Streams:

- Premium guide listing
 - Language-specialized guides
 - Tour bundles
 - Priority booking access
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Platform Architecture (High-Level)

Three main components:

1. Traveler Application
2. Guide Dashboard

3. Admin Control Panel

This structure ensures trust, scalability, and marketplace governance.

Database Design (MVP Level)

Core tables:

Users

Fields:

- id
- name
- email
- phone
- role (traveler / guide)

Guides

Fields:

- id
- user_id
- city
- languages
- hourly_rate
- verified_status
- rating

Bookings

Fields:

- id
- user_id
- guide_id
- date
- status

Places

Fields:

- id
- name

- city
- latitude
- longitude
- category

Itinerary

Fields:

- id
- user_id
- day_number
- place_id
- order_index

Suggested Technology Stack

Frontend:

- React / Next.js

Backend:

- Node.js + Express

Database:

- PostgreSQL

Maps Integration:

- Google Maps API

Authentication:

- Firebase Auth or JWT

Hosting:

- Render / Railway (initial deployment)
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Launch Strategy

Phase 1:

- Select one pilot city
- Onboard 10–20 verified guides
- Release internal MVP
- Collect early user feedback

Phase 2:

- Improve booking workflow
- Improve itinerary optimization
- Introduce ratings & reviews

Phase 3:

- Expand to additional cities
 - Introduce AI travel assistant
 - Add expense management features
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Competitive Positioning

Unlike traditional travel apps that focus on static recommendations or pre-packaged experiences, Guide Connect focuses on real-time human assistance combined with structured itinerary planning.

This enables a hybrid assistance model:

Human guidance + Smart planning automation

Vision

Guide Connect aims to become a smart travel companion platform that provides:

- Instant access to trusted local guides
- Intelligent trip planning support
- Context-aware travel assistance

The long-term goal is to evolve into a unified travel support ecosystem powered by both local expertise and intelligent automation.

Success Metrics (Early Validation)

Initial traction indicators:

- Number of onboarded guides
- Number of completed bookings
- Repeat traveler usage
- Average booking value

These metrics will validate marketplace adoption before scaling to additional cities.